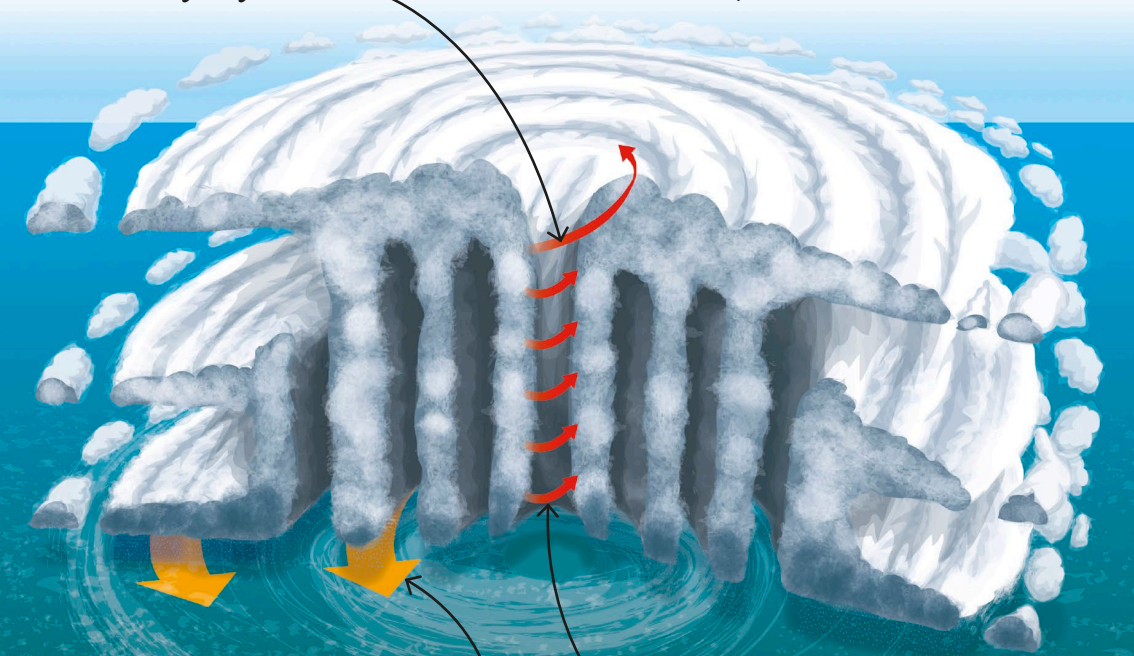


Hurricane slice

What goes on inside a hurricane? Fierce winds hurtle around the bottom of the storm, but the center is dead calm. The air that spirals up around the center builds up tall rain clouds.

Warm, damp air spirals up around the center of the storm, making huge clouds.

Hurricanes may be 900 miles (1,500 km) across and 7 miles (12 km) or more high. Hurricane winds in the Northern Hemisphere spin in the opposite direction of the hurricane winds in the Southern Hemisphere.



Hurricane winds blow around the base of the storm at 185 mph (300 kph) or more.

The air in the very center, or "eye," of the storm is clear and calm.

Every hurricane is given a name. Once, only girls' names such as Jane and Diana were used, but now boys' names are used, too.